



City of islands and waterways

The city of Venice was established on 118 islands in a lagoon in northern Italy. Gondolas and motorboats ferry people up and down the canals of the city.



The tambourine is a vital part of this dance.

Tarantella

A folk dance for couples, the tarantella has fast, lively steps. According to legend, this dance started out as a cure for hysteria brought on by a tarantula spider's bite.



Italian Grand Prix

This Formula 1 race has been held since 1921 on a racetrack near Monza, north of Milan. With 20 victories, Scuderia Ferrari is the most successful team on this circuit.



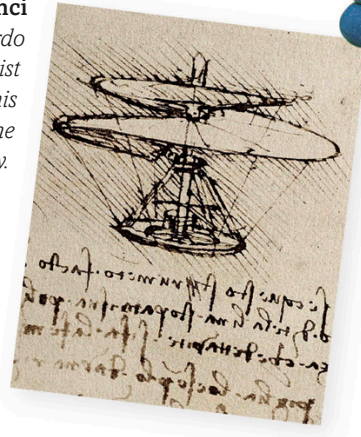
Italian vineyards

Vineyards grow over the 20 regions of Italy, and the wine produced from their grapes is one of the country's major exports.



Leonardo da Vinci

The Italian artist Leonardo da Vinci was also a scientist and inventor, who drew this design for a flying machine in the 15th century.

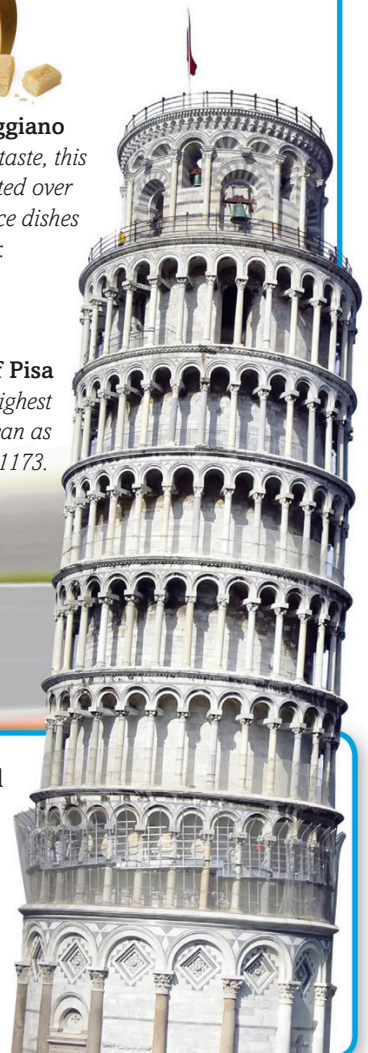


Parmigiano-Reggiano

Known for its nutty taste, this hard cheese is grated over many pasta and rice dishes to add flavor.

Leaning Tower of Pisa

Measuring 183 ft (55.9 m) on its highest side, this iconic tower began to lean as soon as construction started in 1173.



Geography: The Italian peninsula extends from the mountains of the Alps in the north to the island of Sicily in the south.



History: Once the heart of the Roman Empire, Italy fragmented into medieval city-states and kingdoms before unification as a country in 1861.



Culture: Celebrated for its ancient and Renaissance art and architecture, Italy was also the birthplace of opera and is now famous for its movies and fashion.



Food and drink: Italy's healthy diet is known for its pasta, tomatoes, olive oil, and fish but has many regional variations based on local produce.